business processes. Finding what you need will require some laborious searching.

Business case and its complex data needs

To build a viable business case for data mesh, start with answering the following questions:

- Do you have specific business processes that are starting or ongoing with complex data needs?
- Do you need to kick off a product/project with complex data needs to accomplish OKRs?

By *complex data needs*, we mean multidimensional analysis (ad hoc, AI/ML, reporting) running on top of the data coming from multiple sources. If the answers to these questions are positive, you might have a compelling business case.

KEY POINT A data mesh requires a business case and is useful when there are related complex data needs.

Let's look at the examples of business cases and their data needs.

Example 1: Snow-shoveling business

In the example described in chapter 1:

- Candace realized that she combined too many business processes into one data flow. In this way, she lost the data context.
- Adam and Eve had no way of supplementing raw data with their knowledge and experience.
- Bob operated detached from his actual stakeholders.

The business case for a *data mesh-ization* of Candace's shoveling business could improve demand forecasting for shovel ordering.